

Herald — AGENTS.md

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Field	Value
Revision	4
Created	2026-05-15
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Status	active
Status summary	"Project status" updated: Go scaffold landed; build+test commands documented; open HRD list embedded for agent reference.
Issues	none
Issues summary	—
Fixed	R-14 (V2), V3-path-sync (V3 r3), Go-scaffold-status-update (V3 r4)
Fixed summary	aligned with HRD-009/HRD-009b/HRD-013/HRD-014 landing in the same commit.
Continuation	bump again when first-implementation cycle completes HRD-010..HRD-012/HRD-016 live integrations.

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Base agent rules: the Helix Constitution's AGENTS.md, provided by the **parent project's** constitution/ submodule (Herald does not carry its own copy). **READ IT FIRST.**

Discover the constitution by walking up parent directories until you find <ancestor>/constitution/Constitution.md, or by invoking the canonical helper <discovered>/find_constitution.sh. For standalone Herald work, clone the constitution alongside Herald:

```
git clone git@github.com:HelixDevelopment/  
    HelixConstitution.git \  
    $(dirname "$PWD")/constitution
```

The base file is authoritative for any topic not covered here. Herald-specific rules below extend them; they never weaken them.

Canonical: <https://github.com/HelixDevelopment/HelixConstitution>

Critical base rules restated (for agents that don't follow @imports)

- **No bluffing.** Every PASS carries positive evidence. Constitution §11.4 / §1.1.
- **Mutation-paired gates.** Every new gate has a paired mutation proving it catches regressions. Constitution §1.1.
- **No guessing language** (likely, probably, maybe, seems, appears) when reporting causes. Constitution §11.4.6.
- **Credentials never tracked.** .env git-ignored; runtime-load only. Constitution §11.4.10.
- **Never force-push.** Requires explicit per-session authorization.
- **Hardlinked backup before any destructive op.** Constitution §9.
- **60% RAM cap on heavy work.** Constitution §12.6.
- **Multi-upstream push.** Every commit fans out to all 4 hosts (GitHub + GitLab + GitFlic + GitVerse). Constitution §2.1.

Herald-specific agent rules

Project status (load-bearing for every task)

Herald is **pre-implementation**. As of 2026-05-15 the repo contains:

- README.md — mission, deployment model, constitution-inheritance contract, how to run.
- docs/specs/mvp/specification.V3.md — MVP spec (section headings only; substantive content TBD).
- docs/guides/HERALD_CONSTITUTION.md — project-specific constitutional extensions.
- docs/guides/CONSTITUTION_INHERITANCE.md — operator/agent guide for the parent-discovery contract + the gate.
- upstreams/ — Herald's own mirror declarations (lowercase, §11.4.29-compliant).
- tests/test_constitution_inheritance.sh — inheritance gate (read-only assertions).
- tests/test_constitution_inheritance_meta.sh — paired mutation meta-test (§1.1).
- .gitignore tuned for Go (also ignores .DS_Store).

Herald **does not** ship a constitution/ submodule of its own — see docs/guides/CONSTITUTION_INHERITANCE.md for the rationale and the discovery mechanism.

As of 2026-05-20 the Go scaffold landed (first-implementation cycle r1). 5 Go modules (commons, commons_prefix, commons_messaging, commons_storage, pherald) compile + unit tests pass. pherald version --json returns build info. The full §11.0 type contract is realized in commons/types.go. The null:// sandbox adapter is fully working with 8 unit tests. SQL migrations 000001..000005 embedded via //go:embed. Docker/Podman Compose for §26.5 Quickstart shipped under quickstart/ (migrated from containers/quickstart/ when the containers/ submodule landed). On-demand container orchestration is provided by the containers/ submodule (digital.vasic.containers).

Build + test from repo root:

```
go test ./commons/... ./commons_prefix/... ./
commons_messaging/... ./commons_storage/...
go build -o /tmp/pherald-dev ./pherald/cmd/pherald
```

What's NOT yet live (per docs/Issues.md):

- HRD-008 operator-side Quickstart compose validation.
- HRD-010 commons_storage live (pgx + River + Redis).
- HRD-011 Telegram adapter live (telebot + getUpdates).
- HRD-012 Claude Code dispatcher live (claude --resume).
- HRD-016 REST API per §41 (Gin Gonic).

When asked to "add a feature": find the spec section, open / claim the relevant HRD-NNN in docs/Issues.md, write Go + tests, ensure go test passes, close the HRD-NNN by migrating its row to docs/Fixed.md (per Universal §11.4.19 atomic-migration mandate).

Never invent build / test commands beyond go test ./<module>/.... Live-integration tests require operator-supplied bot tokens / Claude sessions / Postgres — docs/CONTINUATION.md carries the handoff prompt.

Inheritance gate (run before any commit that touches root docs or constitution/)

```
bash tests/test_constitution_inheritance.sh      # the gate
bash tests/test_constitution_inheritance_meta.sh # paired
           mutation proof (§1.1)
```

Both MUST return 0. If either fails, fix at root cause per Constitution §11.4.4 — never silently accept the FAIL.

Spec-change rule (load-bearing — docs/specs/mvp/specification.V3.md §"Specification documents")

Whenever docs/specs/mvp/specification.V3.md or any file under docs/specs/ (any depth) is modified, **comprehensive planning and implementation of all changes is MANDATORY** — agents may not edit the spec in isolation. This

rule does NOT apply to creating or renaming files; for those, ask the operator what to do with the new path. Treat every spec edit as a project-wide ripple, not a doc tweak.

This rule is mirrored in CLAUDE.md and in docs/guides/HERALD_CONSTITUTION.md §106. The inheritance gate's invariant **I7a–c** asserts the rule anchor (comprehensive planning and implementation) is present in all three files; a missing copy is a §1.1 propagation bluff and the gate FAILs.

Multi-host mirror convention (Herald's own upstreams)

upstreams/ contains one script per mirror host (GitHub, GitLab, GitFlic, GitVerse). Each script exports UPSTREAMABLE_REPOSITORY and is sourced, not executed. The Herald repo's origin remote is already fan-out (1 fetch URL + 4 push URLs) — a single `git push origin <branch>` propagates to all four hosts. Per-host naming intentionally matches each provider's brand capitalization; do not normalize.

Forbidden in this project

- **Re-adding a constitution/ submodule inside Herald.** Herald is consumed as a submodule of a parent project that already provides constitution/. A duplicate copy inside Herald is a deployment-model violation. The inheritance gate's invariant I6 enforces this — re-adding it will turn the gate red.
- Promoting Herald-specific values into the parent constitution (universal status must be EARNED; see Constitution §11.4 + §11.4.10).
- Modifying any file under the discovered constitution/ from Herald commits — the parent's constitution is read-only from Herald's perspective. Constitution changes go through the HelixConstitution repo directly.
- Adding new submodules without re-running `bash tests/test_constitution_inheritance.sh` afterward.